



Project Shield

NVIDIA unveiled its Project Shield gaming handset at CES, which is powered by Tegra 4

USB 3.0 speed hike

USB 3.0 will see a performance increase as per the announcement by the USB 3.0 Promoter Group. This will double the speed from 5 Gbps to 10 Gbps

Cameras Test

the back. It's really easy to turn without really having to move the thumb a lot. This did, however, at times pose a problem as we found the dial switching on us unexpectedly even with the slightest brush of the thumb.

Build and ergonomics

The comfort of holding a camera can be quite subjective to the hands of the user. However, certain things remain universal, such as the placement of the shutter button, the placement of the zoom toggle and other buttons that are needed to access features. The ergonomics on each of these five cameras were quite decent, though we weren't quite taken in by the sharp corners on the GH210. The best fitting camera (in our hands) was the Fujifilm F660 EXR, which did surprise us a little, seeing how the X10 is anything but an ergonomic marvel.

When we started to play with the Nikon Coolpix L610, we were really intrigued by the design of the camera. It has a really gentle bulge at the top, probably as a result of the large lens, but we haven't seen such curvaceous design cues being implemented in cameras off late. If anything, they have been becoming more angular and clean cut, so the curves are a welcome change. We do however, feel that you might run into issues fitting

this into a camera case that you might have lying around. What we loved the most about the L610, a feature that definitely made it stand out from the rest of the cameras in this competition was the ribbed grip that's replaced the smooth rubber grip that's normally found on such cameras. Speaking of build quality, the Nikons, though obviously made of plastic, they didn't feel flimsy at all. The Fujifilm infact, inspite of the plastic,

built camera out of the five with a well-polished finish, sturdy buttons that were placed just perfectly and the camera itself was a treat to handle.

Performance

The in-studio performance results showed that throughout the range, the Fujifilm F660 EXR dominated the test. Thanks to the slightly larger sensor. It was just ahead of the Nikons up until ISO 1600 and at ISO

over emphasised. While landscape photographers, or those who love shooting leaves might enjoy the Nikons, the F660 EXR offers a better balance of colors. The BenQs offered the same balanced saturation as the Fujifilm F660 EXR, but there is more to the overall story. When we factored in contrast and dynamic range, the F660 did better just by a little bit thanks to its emphasis on shadows in strongly lit scenes. We ended up with lesser "unintentional" silhouettes with the Fuji than we did when shooting with the Nikon or BenQ models.

Verdict

In cameras that are under ₹15,000, we do not really expect stellar performance, especially when we're used to using more high-end imaging devices and these cameras were no exception. We decided that the **Fujifilm F660 EXR** should win our **Best Buy** award for its better performance over the competition (though just by a little bit). The build quality on the Fuji was also surprisingly good, as we're normally used to dealing with cameras that have a flimsy build or poor finish if they cost under 15K. But it looks like Fujifilm cut no corners with this little beauty. We do however wish that it had a faster lens, as that would definitely make this the camera of choice when going anywhere, especially clubbing. **d**



Fujifilm F660EXR

felt like it could withstand a drop or two. The BenQ cameras on the other hand felt as fragile as egg shells in our hands. The battery door was one of the flimsiest we've ever seen, operating on a very delicate spring-hinge mechanism. The GH210 felt mostly like a toy camera with an incredibly thin plastic shell that creaked at the slightest pressure from our fingers. Overall, the Fujifilm F660 EXR was the best

3200, the retention of detail was visibly higher compared to the Nikons and the BenQs.

The real world tests were a rather exciting comparison, with the performance becoming quite hard to gauge. For example, the Nikon S8200 had a very pleasing level of saturation, with a strong emphasis on greens. The Fuji on the other hand had slightly lower saturation (on default setting), but the greens were not

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